

# Week 3 — Pulse Diagnosis

EAM310 · East Asian Medicine Diagnosis I · VUIM Summer 2026

⚠ Quiz 2 — July 24, 2026

Class: Friday July 25, 2026 · 9AM-1PM

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## REQUIRED READINGS — due before July 25

### FCM CHAPTER 25 — MACIOCIA

- The Normal Pulse (平脈 Ping Mài)
- Three essential qualities: 胃神根
- 28 pulse qualities — full descriptions
- Clinical groupings by pattern
- Pulse qualities at individual positions

### CAM CHAPTER 13 — CHENG XINNONG

- Normal pulse description
- 28 pathological pulse types
- Yin/Yang classification of pulses
- Pulse-taking method review
- Pulse qualities in disease

## WEEK 3 LEARNING OBJECTIVES (CLO 1, 4, 5, 6)

- Describe the characteristics of a normal pulse
- Name the three essential qualities (胃神根) and explain each
- Identify the 28 classical pulse qualities by feel and name
- Classify pulses by Yin/Yang grouping (CAM framework)
- Explain what each pulse quality indicates clinically
- Differentiate easily confused pulse pairs (e.g., Wiry vs Tight)
- Apply pulse findings to the six positions bilaterally
- Integrate pulse with tongue for pattern differentiation

## ASSESSMENT CALENDAR

| Date   | Event                  | Material Covered                                              |
|--------|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Jul 24 | ⚠ Quiz 2               | Week 2: Four Pillars, 8 Principles, Tongue intro, Pulse intro |
| Jul 25 | Week 3 Class           | Normal Pulse, 28 Pulse Qualities, in-class palpation practice |
| Jul 31 | Quiz 3                 | Week 3 material — Pulse Diagnosis                             |
| Aug 7  | MIDTERM + Journal 1-25 | Weeks 1-4 comprehensive                                       |
| Sep 11 | FINAL + Journal 26-50  | Weeks 6-9 comprehensive                                       |

## IN-CLASS PRACTICE — What to expect Friday

### PALPATION LAB

Week 3 includes hands-on in-class practice on pulse palpation. Come ready to:

- Practice three-finger placement on a partner (Cun/Guan/Chi bilaterally)
- Identify depth levels — superficial, middle, deep
- Attempt to name at least 3-5 qualities you feel in a live practice pulse
- Document your findings in your Pulse/Tongue Journal (entry counts toward midterm)

# EAM Diagnosis Notes — Week 3

Pulse Diagnosis Cheat Sheet · 脈診 Mài Zhěn

FCM Ch.25 · CAM Ch.13

July 25, 2026

## PULSE POSITIONS — 寸關尺 · Both Hands

| Hand                      | Cun 寸 (distal)                             | Guan 關 (middle)     | Chi 尺 (proximal)                        |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| <b>Left</b><br>Heart side | Heart / SM Intestine<br>chest, Pericardium | Liver / Gallbladder | Kidney Yin / Bladder<br>Lower Jiao (L)  |
| <b>Right</b><br>Lung side | Lung / LG Intestine<br>chest               | Spleen / Stomach    | Kidney Yang / Bladder<br>Lower Jiao (R) |

## NORMAL PULSE 平脈 · Three Essentials 胃神根

| Quality         | Normal Finding                  | Essential     | Meaning                         |
|-----------------|---------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>Rate</b>     | 4–5 beats/resp · 72–80 bpm      | 胃 <b>Wèi</b>  | Stomach Qi: flowing, harmonious |
| <b>Depth</b>    | Middle level — not too sup/deep | 神 <b>Shén</b> | Spirit: strong, rhythmical      |
| <b>Strength</b> | Forceful but not excessive      | 根 <b>Gēn</b>  | Root: deep at Chi — Kidney Qi   |
| <b>Rhythm</b>   | Regular — no skipped beats      |               |                                 |

## 28 PULSE QUALITIES — Quick Reference

| ↑ FLOATING GROUP            |                      | RATE GROUP          |                              | WIDTH / SHAPE GROUP     |                              |
|-----------------------------|----------------------|---------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------------|
| 浮 <b>Fú</b> Floating        | Exterior / Yin def   | 數 <b>Shuò</b> Rapid | >5/resp — Heat               | 弦 <b>Xián</b> Wiry      | Liver · pain · violin string |
| 芤 <b>Kōu</b> Hollow         | Blood/fluid loss     | 遲 <b>Chí</b> Slow   | <4/resp — Cold               | 滑 <b>Huá</b> Slippery   | Phlegm · pearls rolling      |
| 革 <b>Gé</b> Leather         | Jing/Blood loss      | 疾 <b>Jí</b> Racing  | >7/resp — extreme Heat       | 澀 <b>Sè</b> Choppy      | Blood stasis · scraping      |
| ↓ SINKING GROUP             |                      | STRENGTH GROUP      |                              | 洪 <b>Hóng</b> Flooding  | Excess Heat · wave           |
| 沉 <b>Chén</b> Deep          | Interior             | 實 <b>Shí</b> Full   | Excess — forceful all levels | 細 <b>Xì</b> Thin        | Blood def · thread           |
| 牢 <b>Láo</b> Firm           | Cold accumulation    | 虛 <b>Xū</b> Empty   | Def — weak all levels        | 濡 <b>Rú</b> Soggy       | Damp · float+thin+soft       |
| 伏 <b>Fú</b> Hidden          | Severe Interior Cold | 弱 <b>Ruò</b> Weak   | Deep + fine + soft           | 長 <b>Cháng</b> Long     | Excess · past positions      |
| RHYTHM GROUP                |                      | 微 <b>Wēi</b> Frail  | Barely perceptible           | 短 <b>Duǎn</b> Short     | Qi def/stag · one position   |
| 結 <b>Jié</b> Knotted        | Slow + irreg. skips  |                     |                              | 緊 <b>Jǐn</b> Tight      | Cold · twisted rope          |
| 促 <b>Cù</b> Hurried         | Rapid + irreg. skips |                     |                              | 大 <b>Dà</b> Overflowing | Full Heat · wide             |
| 代 <b>Dài</b> Reg. Intermit. | Slow + fixed gaps △  |                     |                              |                         |                              |

### △ KEY DISTINCTIONS TO KNOW COLD

**Wiry vs Tight:** Wiry = taut violin string · Tight = twisted vibrating rope (colder, more pain) | **Slippery vs Flooding:** Slippery = smooth rolling (normal width) · Flooding = large wave (big force) | 代 **Dài** = **worst rhythm:** regular fixed-interval skips = organ Qi declining

# EAM Diagnosis Notes

EAM310 · EAM Diagnosis I · Prof. Schrier · Friday 9AM-1PM · Room 303

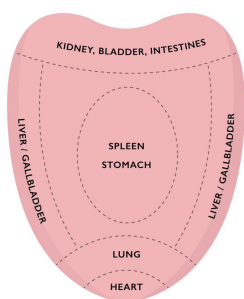
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July 25, 2026

| PATTERN NAME | DISEASE CATEGORY | WEEK / QUIZ |
|--------------|------------------|-------------|
|              |                  |             |
| ETIOLOGY     | ORGAN SYSTEM     | DATE        |
|              |                  |             |

## CLINICAL ESSENTIALS · TONGUE · PULSE · TREATMENT PRINCIPLE

### TONGUE 舌診

CHINESE MEDICINE  
TONGUE MAP



### COLOR / COAT / SHAPE

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### PULSE 脈診 · CUN · GUAN · CHI

| Wrist      | CUN 寸 | GUAN 關 | CHI 尺   |
|------------|-------|--------|---------|
| L<br>HT/PC |       | LV/GB  | KD-Yin  |
| R<br>LU/LI |       | SP/ST  | KD-Yang |

### QUALITY / OVERALL

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### TREATMENT PRINCIPLE 治則

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### KEY POINTS / HERBS

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